

THOUGHTWAVEAI

Installation Guide

One-time setup for Windows and macOS

What this guide covers Account setup, LLM configuration, local speech setup, speech-model download, and final verification.

Before You Begin

ThoughtWaveAI checks the required local speech components during setup. You do not need to prepare them in advance, but an internet connection is required while Python, Whisper, or the speech model is being downloaded.

- Requires 64-bit Python 3.10 or later. ThoughtWaveAI prompts you if a compatible version is not available.
- Creates a .venv-whisper folder inside ThoughtWaveAI app data for the managed local speech environment.
- Installs Whisper into that environment using pip; administrator rights are not normally required.
- Downloads and load-verifies the required base speech model before setup can finish.

Important “Installed” is not the same as “Ready.” ThoughtWaveAI verifies the Python runtime, PyTorch, Whisper and the speech model before setup can continue.

macOS note: The overall setup flow is the same on Windows and macOS: ThoughtWaveAI verifies Python, creates a managed local speech environment, installs Whisper, checks PyTorch and Whisper, downloads the required speech model, and verifies that the model can load successfully.

On macOS, the file paths and Python installation steps differ from Windows. Depending on the Mac, Python may already be available or may need to be installed separately. Apple Silicon and Intel Macs also use different builds.

ThoughtWaveAI includes separate macOS builds for Apple Silicon and Intel. Detailed Mac troubleshooting steps will be expanded after additional packaged testing on real Mac hardware.

Step 1 — Terms & Privacy

Review and accept the Terms of Use and Privacy Notice.

Step 2 — Welcome

A short introduction to ThoughtWaveAI and the one-time setup.

Step 3 — Account Setup

Enter a valid email address for your ThoughtWaveAI access.

Step 4 — LLM Configuration

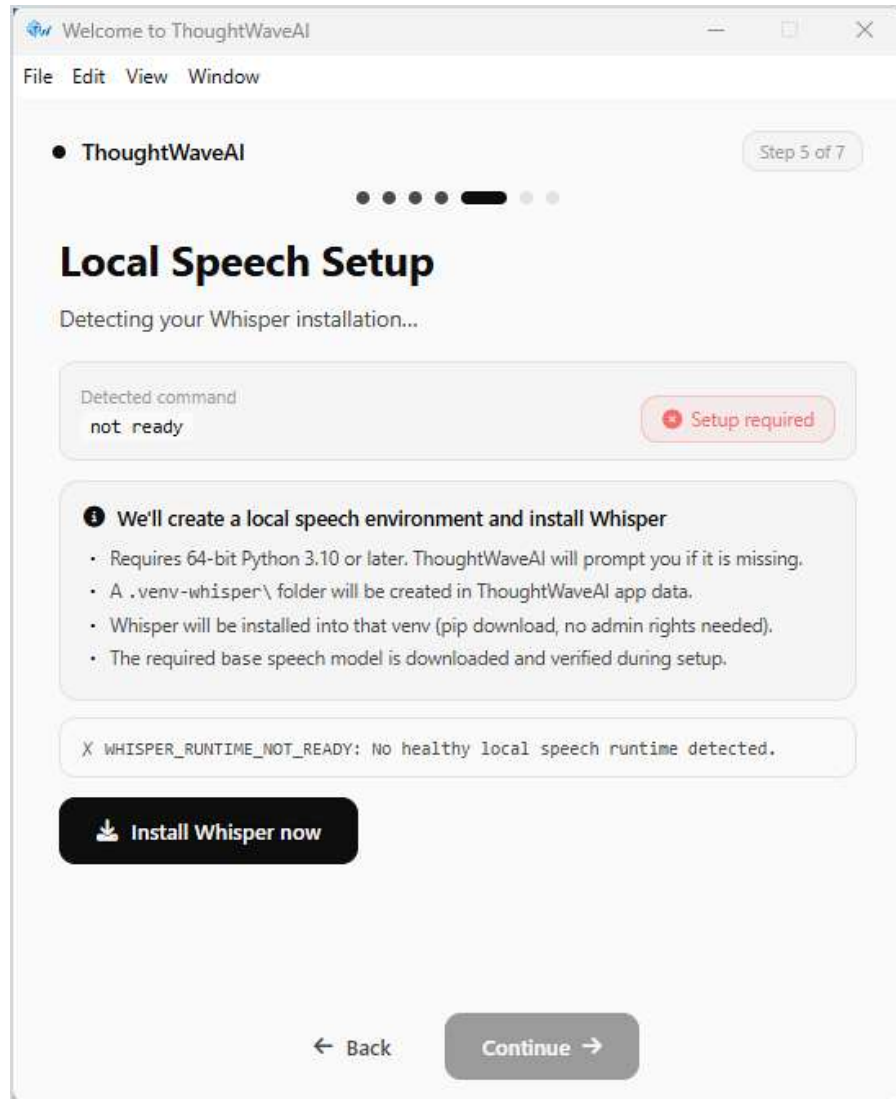
Add the credentials for the AI provider you want ThoughtWaveAI to use, select a supported model, and test the configuration before continuing.

Tip — Prefer a fast inference model for live use. ThoughtWaveAI is designed to surface intelligence while the conversation is happening. For the best live experience, choose a supported model with low latency and fast inference. Larger or more reasoning-intensive models may provide deeper responses but can introduce additional delay.

You can change the provider or model later in ThoughtWaveAI settings.

Step 5 of 7 — Local Speech Setup

ThoughtWaveAI first checks whether a healthy local speech runtime already exists. If no verified runtime is available, the screen shows Setup required.



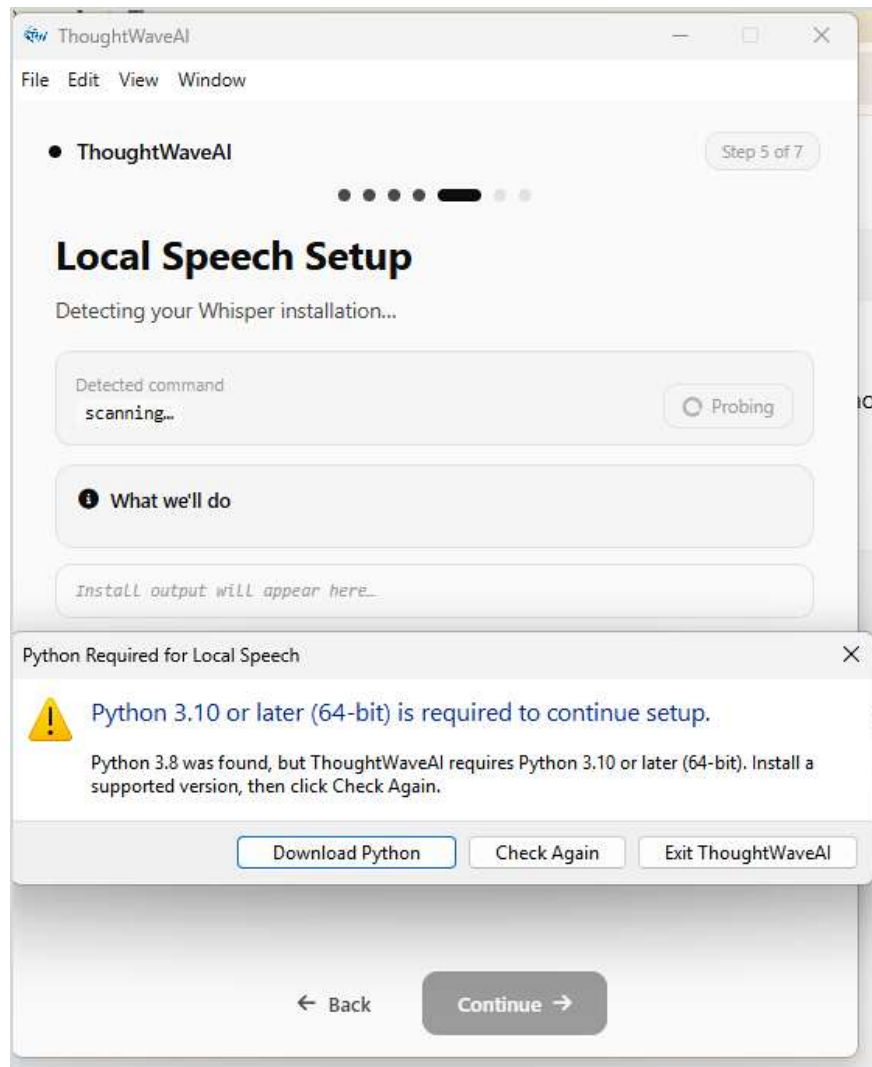
If no healthy local speech runtime is detected, choose Install Whisper now.

1. Click Install Whisper now.
2. ThoughtWaveAI checks Python, creates the managed .venv-whisper environment, installs Whisper and verifies PyTorch and Whisper imports.
3. Wait for verification to complete. Continue becomes available once the runtime is installed and verified.

Expected behavior Continue should enable automatically after successful verification. You should not need to go Back and return to this page.

If Python is missing or outdated

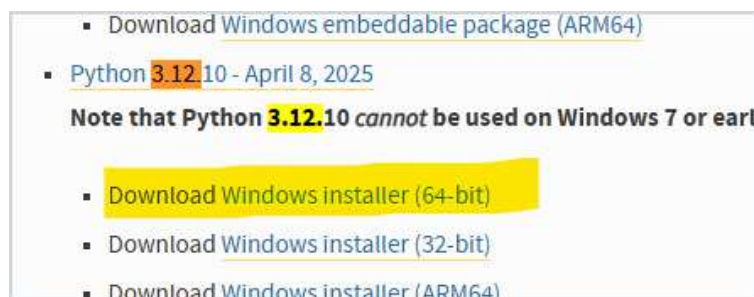
If ThoughtWaveAI finds Python 3.8 or another incompatible runtime, setup is blocked until a supported 64-bit Python version is available.



Example: Python 3.8 was detected; ThoughtWaveAI requires Python 3.10 or later (64-bit).

Install a supported Python version

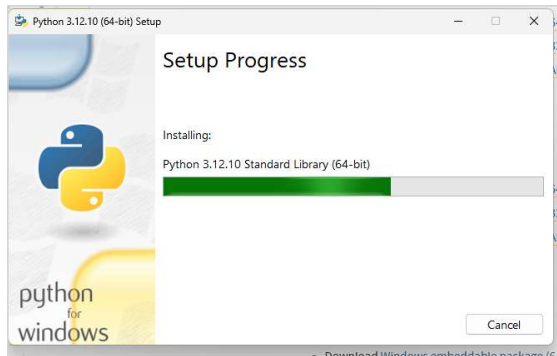
4. Click Download Python to open the Python for Windows downloads page.
5. Choose a Windows installer (64-bit) for a supported Python 3.10 or later release. Python 3.12.10 (64-bit) has been validated with ThoughtWaveAI.



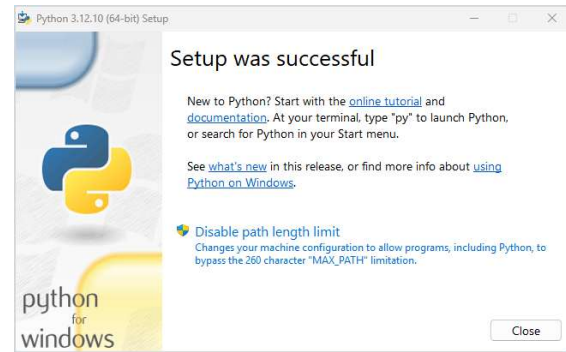
Example: choose the 64-bit Windows installer for the supported Python release.

Complete the Python installation

Run the installer and allow setup to finish. The screenshots below show the validated Python 3.12.10 (64-bit) installation path.



Installation in progress.



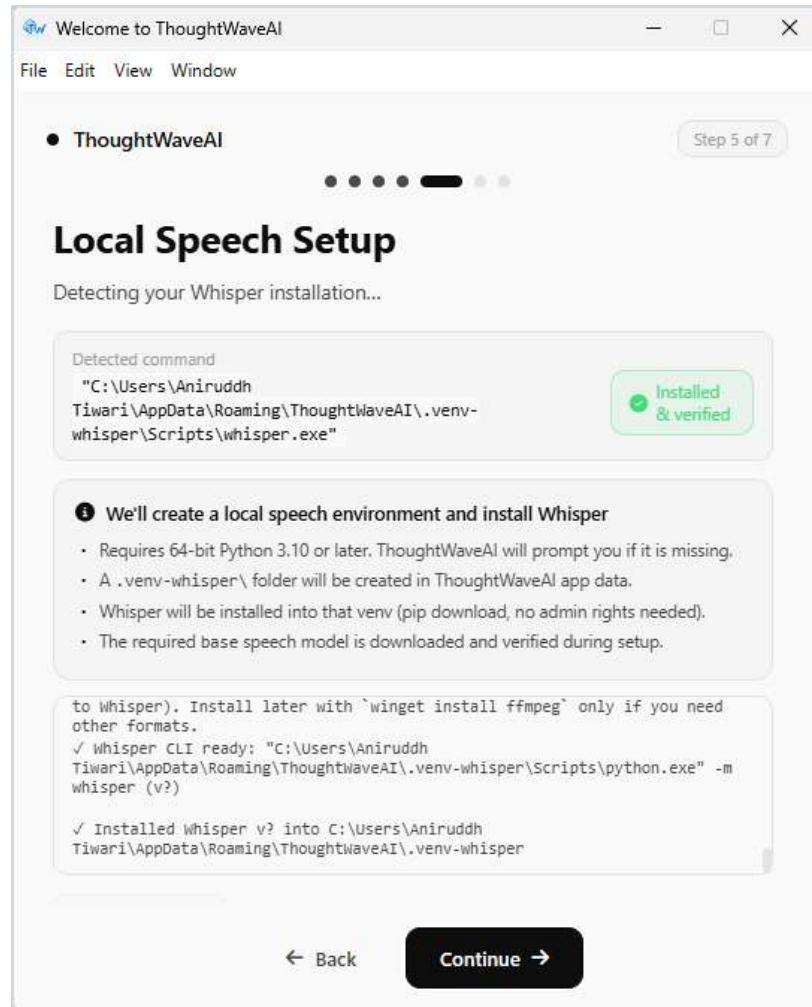
Setup completed successfully.

Return to ThoughtWaveAI Close the Python installer, return to ThoughtWaveAI, and click Check Again.

If ThoughtWaveAI still reports the previous Python version after Check Again, close ThoughtWaveAI completely and reopen it once. This refreshes the process environment before setup continues.

Step 5 complete — Runtime verified

After installation, ThoughtWaveAI performs runtime health checks and shows Installed & verified when the local speech environment is ready.

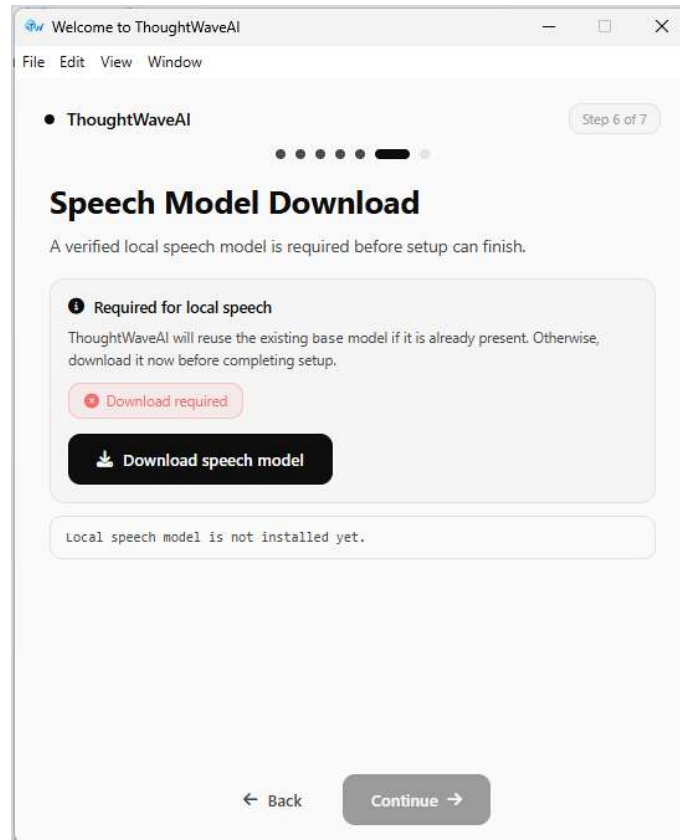


Local speech runtime installed and verified. Continue is enabled automatically.

What is verified A usable Python runtime, PyTorch import, Whisper import and the managed Whisper command are checked before this step is considered ready.

Step 6 of 7 — Speech Model Download

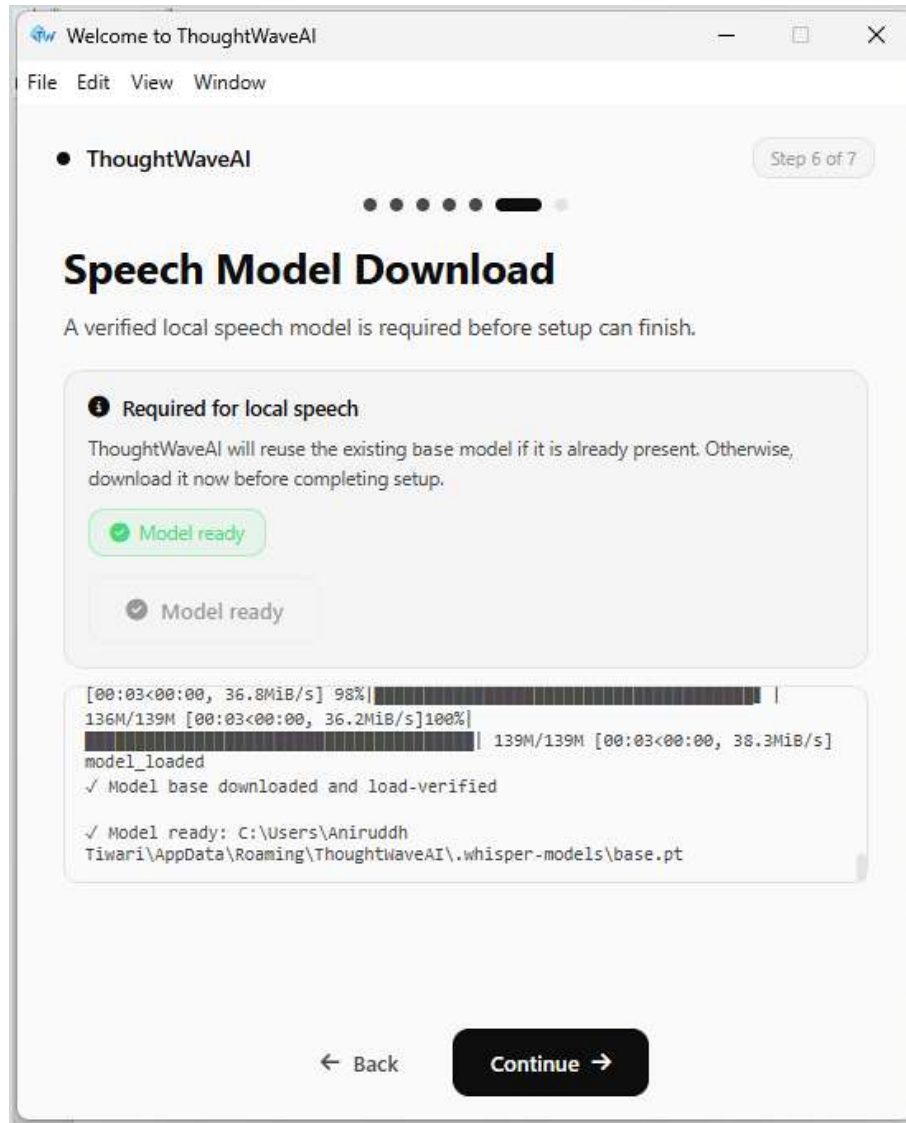
If the required base model is not already present, the page shows Download required. Click Download speech model.



Download the base model if it is not installed.

Download and verify the speech model

6. Click Download speech model.
7. Wait while the model downloads.
8. ThoughtWaveAI loads the model to verify that it is usable.
9. When Model ready appears and Continue is enabled, click Continue.

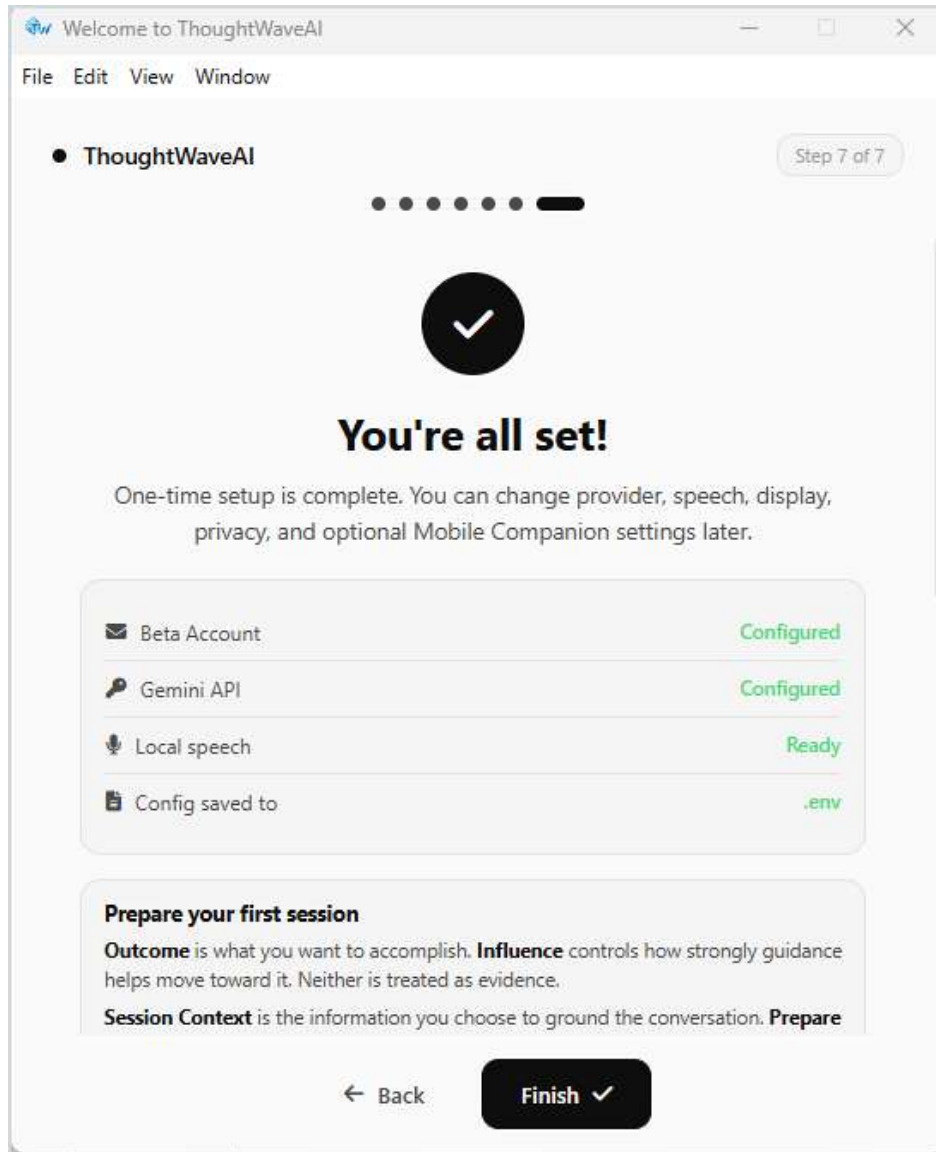


The base model has downloaded and passed load verification.

Do not close setup during verification The model is not considered ready until ThoughtWaveAI has successfully load-verified it.

Step 7 of 7 — You're All Set

The final page confirms that your account, AI provider configuration and local speech setup are ready, and gives a short orientation for your first session.



Final setup confirmation.

Click Finish to complete setup and open ThoughtWaveAI.

Need help? If you run into a setup issue that is not covered here, use the ThoughtWaveAI beta feedback channel and include the error code shown by the app when available.